

USING THE FIVE

# Cool, not cold

— **Off-white** on the walls bounces the long light without glaring. A true brilliant white turns blue and hard in July sun; keep the warmth in it.

— **Oat** is the cloth, lighter and less of it than in winter. One linen layer, not three. The bed loses its quilt; the sofa loses its throw.

— **Bleached oak** is the season's wood — pale, dry, the colour of driftwood and sun. It reads cooler than walnut without going grey.

— **Cool stone** is the new neutral object — a grey-glazed jug, an unglazed bowl. It is where the eye goes to feel a few degrees cooler.

— **Faded indigo** is the one cool accent, used as sparingly as winter's ember — a single dipped cushion, a stripe on a tea towel, the spine of one book. One note of blue in a warm room reads like shade.

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Subtract a layer for the season. The coolest room in the house owns the least.

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